



Roman Staroseltsev

Senior Backend Developer (*Full-time*)

Full development cycle – from idea to release

PHP · OOP · Laravel · MySQL · Nginx · REST API · Linux · Docker

Contacts

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Career milestones

Senior PHP Developer: since Nov 2017 – Relevant exp.

Commercial PHP development: ... since July 2011

Career start: April 2001

About me

- I see the business context behind code and understand how technical decisions impact product profitability.
- Focus areas: architecture, integrations, testing, full-cycle development, optimization, and maintenance.
- Goal: to help teams build valuable products while growing in architecture and system design; committed to long-term work with legacy and regulated systems.
- Work formats: remote / on-site / hybrid; Engagement: B2B (sole proprietor in Georgia), B2C Contractor.
- Education: Higher technical education (Specialist degree) in Information Systems Technologies (SSGA). postgraduate studies at SB RAS Institute of Nuclear Physics. English level: B2.

Key Achievements (2017 – Present)

- 6 production projects, including high-load, across fintech, insurTech, gameDev, travelTech, and marketing.
- Designed and launched 3 products from scratch through to profitable operation.
- Led architecture design, standardized development processes, and introduced DevOps practices.
- Collaborated with clients and distributed teams across Russia, the EU, and the US.

Technical skills and stack

Backend:

- ~ Primary language: **PHP** 7.1–8.4 (OOP, MVC, SOLID, DRY, KISS)
- ~ Frameworks: **Laravel** 5.8–11, Symfony 3.4–5.1, Phalcon 3.4, Zend, Kohana, CakePHP, CodeIgniter
- ~ Architecture: DDD, hexagonal, REST API, microservices, queues, caching
- ~ Tools: PhpStorm, DataGrip, Xdebug, Composer, Guzzle, Curl, RegExp, npm, PM2, Webpack
- ~ API tools: Postman, Stoplight, Swagger
- ~ Code quality: PHPUnit, PHPStan, PHPCS, PHP CS Fixer
- ~ Template engines: Blade, Twig
- ~ Other languages: Node.js, Perl, C

Frontend: HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, Ajax, Vue.js, jQuery, jQuery Mobile, Underscore.js, Bootstrap, AdminLTE, DataTables, Highcharts / Highstock, jqPlot, Select2, Google Maps API, JS-packages

Data Storage (DBMS): MySQL, MariaDB, ORM and SQL, Redis, MongoDB, Elasticsearch, ClickHouse, S3-compatible storages

API and integrations: PayPal, Stripe, 123x, Indacoin, Sber, Tinkoff, JWTAuth, OAuth, Slack API, Twilio API, KYC/AML, PrerenderIO, SMS-gateways

Infrastructure and DevOps: Ubuntu / Debian Linux, Docker, GitLab CI/CD, Nginx, Apache, Yandex Cloud, Teleport, Certbot, Cloudflare, iptables, SSH, crontab

Monitoring and QA: Kibana, Grafana, Sentry, Smoke-testing

Project management and teamwork: Git (GitHub, GitLab, Bitbucket), Jira, YouTrack, Trello, Redmine, Confluence, Slack, Discord, Agile/Scrum, Kanban

⚙️ Professional Experience

1. 💡 Independent Backend Developer / Open Source — 01.2026–Present

Independent backend development, architecture design, Open Source, and commercial solutions.

✅ Key Achievements:

- **L9STK** :: <https://github.com/src83/l9stk>

Developed a Starter Kit for Laravel applications based on a modular monolith architecture.

Goal: reduce the cost of starting a project while maintaining feature isolation within modules and the ability to scale the application without prematurely moving to microservices.

The architecture enables functional modules to be isolated, transferred, and reused across projects, accelerating the development of new products. It is suitable for small and medium-sized applications, hypothesis validation, and prototyping both individual features and entire sections.

- **L9STK Chat** :: <https://github.com/src83/l9stk-chat>

Developed and deployed a production web chat as an alternative communication channel in response to limited availability of traditional messaging services. After validating and stabilizing the solution, extracted the chat functionality into a standalone reusable **module**, integrated it into the modular architecture of a Laravel application based on **L9STK**, and continued maintaining and supporting the solution. The solution has been running reliably in production ever since.

- **Laravel API Response** (Open Source) :: <https://packagist.org/packages/src83/laravel-api-response>

Developed and published an Open Source package on **Packagist** for standardizing REST API responses and exception handling. Unified JSON contract for successful and error responses, centralized exception handling, modular localization (standardized message keys), pagination, logging and request context, request execution time tracking. Implemented an adaptive installer for integrating the package into both new and existing Laravel applications, including support for existing custom Handlers. Covered the solution with unit and feature tests, PHPStan/Larastan Level 8, Pint, and configured CI with GitHub Actions.

Approach: identified a recurring API standardization problem → generalized the solution and packaged it as a reusable Open Source library → integrated the package back into the application → validated it on a complete application module.

- **L9STK Earthquake** (LarBase) :: <https://github.com/src83/larbase>

Integrated `laravel-api-response` into a Laravel application based on L9STK and implemented a complete Earthquake module with an API, CRUD, console command, configuration, localization, and tests.

Used the module to comprehensively validate the integration of the Open Source package with the modular monolith architecture; after publishing the package, switched the application from a local dependency to the **Packagist** version.

- **Hacı Saad** (Demo) :: <https://hacisaad.0xsrc.uk>

Developed a commercial website with a mobile-first interface and a dedicated QR menu for a local restaurant business in Turkey and presented the completed solution to a prospective client. Implemented a multilingual dynamic menu catalog in TR|EN|RU|DE, responsive/mobile UX, interactive navigation, and required integrations.

Approach: independently identified a local market niche → identified a potential client and their problem → developed an MVP solution (commercial prototype) → adapted it to the specific business (multilingual support + QR menu + SEO + mobile QA) → deployed the solution → prepared and delivered a commercial presentation.

1. 🎮 NDA (gaming / highload marketplace, EU) — 2025–2026

- Developed and delivered multiple product features involving API contract changes and synchronized logic across layers (API gateway, admin panel, core service);
- Designed and launched a referral/affiliate system: tiers, analytics, auto-generated codes, multi-currency support, payouts, and transaction history;
- Extended event-related API modules: user stats, leaderboards, banners, offers, coin accrual and adjustments;
- Enhanced payment and bonus logic: deposit limits, bonus scenario switching, payment method labels;
- Optimized SQL queries and caching, improving API stability;
- Expanded the admin content management module (main slider);
- Maintained release stability: linters, unit tests, monitoring via Kibana and Sentry;
- Delivered full-cycle development from epic analysis and estimation to production release.

✓ **Business results:**

- Built and launched the referral system from scratch to production;
- Migrated static asset storage to external S3;
- Strengthened platform monetization (referrals, bonus mechanics, events, leaderboards, limits);
- Improved API reliability through refactoring and test coverage of core logic;
- Enhanced user experience via new retention features (stats, promo codes, referrals).

2. 🛡️ **Rososmotr** (insurTech, SaaS, B2B property inspection management platform) — 2024–2025

- Reworked company assignment and permission inheritance logic during user creation, reducing misconfiguration risks and manual fixes;
- Implemented a deadline-missed webhook and enhanced the integration API, improving SLA control and external system reliability;
- Resolved loops and hanging flows in multi-inspections; introduced an archiving mechanism;
- Extended change history (deadlines, statuses), improving transparency and auditability;
- Added safeguards against duplicate actions and data duplication, reducing incidents and support load.

✓ **Business results:**

- Improved stability of process logic;
- Reduced operational risk and increased platform predictability in complex business scenarios.

3. 🇺🇸 **NDA** (finTech, highload processing platform) — 2023–2024

- Built payment system (PSP) integrations from scratch and embedded them into the processing platform architecture;
- Integrated and configured new PSPs, expanding payment method coverage (cards/APMs);
- Configured and tested 100+ payment methods within connected PSPs, ensuring correct handling of statuses, authorization, and clearing;
- Enhanced and stabilized existing integrations: status handling, webhooks, retries, and edge cases, reducing inconsistent transaction states;
- Analyzed transaction flows and incidents via Kibana; participated in investigations of failures, status discrepancies, and idempotency issues.

✓ **Business results:**

- Integrated multiple PSPs and supported/customized 100+ payment methods within the platform;
- Expanded P2P payment functionality with new transfer scenarios;
- Increased coverage of payment flows and available payment methods.

4. 🏠 **Siren Group AG** (leadgen / marketing, US market) — 2021–2023

- Participated in all phases of architectural transformation: Symfony monolith → microservices → consolidated Laravel monolith;
- Integrated dozens of clients across 10 business verticals;
- Built a Slack notification system for the media buying team;
- Contributed to integrating 3 new verticals;
- Maintained and enhanced an internal Symfony-based ERP/CRM for lead management;
- Refactored autonomous service subsystems reused across platform versions.
- Developed and delivered parts of the public and internal API for the new Laravel-based platform;
- Standardized development processes by introducing internal engineering guidelines;
- Updated API documentation (Stoplight) and internal process docs (Confluence);
- Built a Docker setup from scratch for local dev infrastructure and presented it to the team;
- Participated in team processes: architecture meetups, cross-code reviews, planning poker;
- Enhanced and stabilized business logic, including DB optimization, refactoring, and test coverage.

✓ **Business results:**

- The company achieved over 25% year-over-year financial growth.

5. 🚢 **AnyShips** (travel-tech) && 🗺️ **SwapMap** (geo-social) — 2019–2021

- Designed backend architecture, database schema, admin panel, and REST API using Laravel;
- Fully rewrote the product from a legacy stack to a new architecture, migrated data, and ensured a seamless production transition;
- Implemented complex domain logic: pricing models, processing statuses, user roles, JWT authentication;
- Built an integration layer for external APIs (payments, CRM, SMS gateways, partner services);
- Integrated payment systems (Sber, Tinkoff), ensuring accurate payment tracking, order processing, and financial control.
- Set up infrastructure in Yandex Cloud, including CI/CD pipelines, monitoring, and alerting system;
- Acted as Tech Lead: made architectural decisions and led a backend team (2 developers);
- Acted as analyst and PM: gathered requirements, formalized specs, performed task breakdown, prioritization, planning, and demos;
- Established a structured development process: task tracking, sprints, estimations, GitFlow, code review, and technical debt/schedule control;
- Designed and delivered SwapMap, a high-load social platform with large-scale production data.

✅ **Business results:**

- Both products were built from scratch and brought to profitable production use;
- Both operate under real user load and remain stable with a resilient architecture;
- AnyShips geography: 20+ countries and 200+ cities;
- Social network with large-scale data (20M+ records, 165k+ users, 165M+ views);
- Complex domain logic including check-ins, events, PPL points, messaging, and bulk contact imports.

6. 🏠 **CryptoB2B** (finTech, blockchain) — 2017–2019

- Developed core modules of the ICO platform and supporting microservices;
- Built a blockchain parsing service supporting 15 cryptocurrencies;
- Designed and implemented a token accounting system;
- Ensured reliable intake and accurate processing of transactions;
- Optimized bulk token distribution (tens of thousands of participants), reducing fees significantly and eliminating manual operations;
- Integrated 3 fiat payment systems and the Blockpass KYC/AML provider, ensuring compliance requirements;
- Solely maintained company infrastructure and active ICO projects for 6 months.

✅ **Result:** Launched 10 ICO projects (Europe, CIS), raising hundreds of thousands of dollars in investments.